QUALITY ASSURANCE NEWSLETTER

September, 2026 LAGOS STATE HEALTH MANAGEMENT AGENCY Quarter 3

Message from the Permanent Secretary, LASHMA

Dr Emmanuella Zamba



As we enter the final quarter of 2026, I commend a number of our healthcare providers for the commitment demonstrated towards improving the quality of care delivered to enrollees across Lagos State.

The third quarter has provided valuable lessons and opportunities for improvement. While we have seen encouraging progress in several areas, our quality assessments have also highlighted gaps that require renewed attention. These findings should not be viewed merely as assessment outcomes, but as opportunities to strengthen our systems, improve patient experiences, and ultimately save lives. As we approach the close of the year, I encourage every healthcare facility to reflect on its quality performance and ask a simple but important question: *What can we do better before the year ends?*

Quality improvement is not a onetime exercise. It is a continuous commitment to safer care, better outcomes, greater dignity for patients, and increased confidence in our healthcare system. Every improvement however small contributes to building a stronger and more trusted healthcare system for the people of Lagos.

I therefore urge all providers to use the final quarter not simply to meet requirements, but to *close identified gaps, strengthen accountability, empower their teams, and embed a culture of continuous improvement.*

Let us finish 2026 stronger than we started it, and continue to make *quality care not just an expectation, but the standard for every ILERA EKO enrollee.*

I wish you all a productive and impactful final quarter.

In this edition

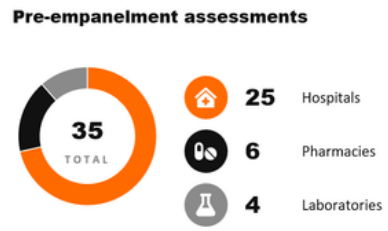
Quality by the numbers.

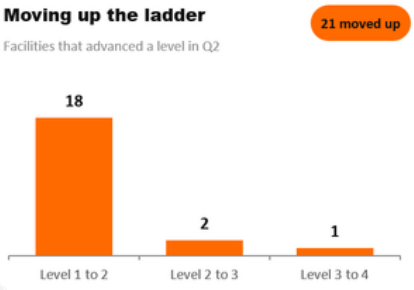
The Quality Officers Notebook.

Celebrating Quality Improvement Milestones.

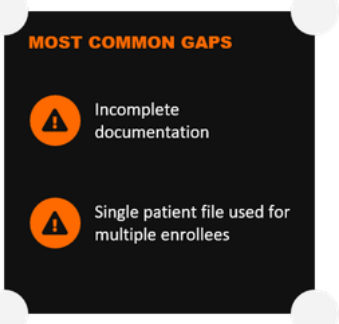
Celebrating World Patient Safety Day.

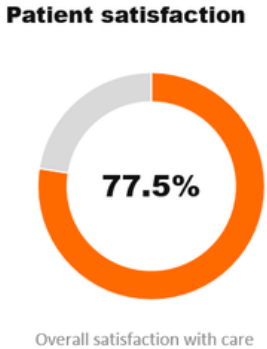
Metrics











THE QUALITY OFFICER'S NOTEBOOK

THE DEFIBRILLATOR WAS READY. WAS THE TEAM?

It was a routine pre-empanelment assessment.
The Quality Officer arrived at a clinic seeking to join the LASHMA provider network and began reviewing the facility's readiness to provide safe care.
Then came the emergency equipment check.

A resuscitation machine/defibrillator was available. Good.
There was just one small problem.
It was still in its original packaging.
The Quality Officer asked the Matron:

"Do you know how to use the machine?"

Yes," "came the confident response.
So came the next, very reasonable question:

"Please demonstrate how you would use it."

And suddenly, the confidence disappeared.
The machine was there.
The staff member knew it was there.

She knew what it was supposed to do.

But she could not demonstrate how to use it.

It was one of those moments that was both amusing and alarming.



THE LESSON?

Equipment does not save lives. Prepared people using the right equipment do.

A defibrillator sitting unopened in its packaging cannot resuscitate a patient. An oxygen cylinder that staff do not know how to use cannot support a patient in respiratory distress. An emergency trolley that has never been checked cannot guarantee that the right drugs and equipment will be available when they are needed.
Healthcare facilities must therefore look beyond "Do we have it?"

QUALITY CHECK

Take a look around your facility today.
Pick one piece of emergency equipment and ask a member of staff to demonstrate its use.
Don't tell them the answer.
You may be surprised by what you discover.
Because in healthcare, readiness is not measured by what is sitting on the shelf. It is measured by what your team can do when a patient's life depends on it.

SEPTEMBER. 2026

CLIMBING THE QUALITY LADDER



Pacific Hospital

Quality Level 4

Lifesource Hospital



Quality Level 3

Golden Cross Hospital

QUALITY OFFICERS' NOTES

Moving from Level 2 to Level 3 is not simply about getting a higher score. It is about demonstrating that quality practices are becoming part of how the facility operates, not just what is presented during an assessment.

WHO IS NEXT?

Every provider has an opportunity to improve. Whether your facility is currently at Level 1, 2, 3 or 4, the next level begins with identifying your gaps, taking action and sustaining the gains.

World Patient Safety Day 2026

Safe Care for Noncommunicable Diseases

Safe Care for Life

PATIENT SAFETY CHALLENGE

WOULD YOU CATCH THE RISK?

Look carefully. There are 5 patient-safety risks hiding in this story.



RISK #1

SPOT THE RISK

Amina gets a new prescription. Nobody asks her what medicines she is already taking.

Medication reconciliation matters.

RISK #2

SPOT THE RISK

Amina visits another facility. Her previous test results aren't available, so she repeats the same tests.

Fragmented care can create safety risks.

RISK #3

SPOT THE RISK

Amina doesn't understand why she needs to take one of her medicines every day. She is too embarrassed to ask.

Patients need information and permission to ask questions.

RISK #4

SPOT THE RISK

Her blood pressure has been unusually high for several visits. Nobody follows up on the pattern.

Missed warning signs can become safety risks.

RISK #5

SPOT THE RISK

Amina goes home with instructions she doesn't fully understand. She isn't sure when she should return or when her symptoms require urgent attention.

Safe care doesn't stop at the hospital door.

THE REVEAL

How many did you spot?

Patient safety in NCD care isn't just about what happens during a consultation. It's about the whole journey:

SAFE CARE FOR LIFE!

PREVENTION → SCREENING → DIAGNOSIS → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP → SELF-CARE

PICTURE Gallery



Clinical Audit

QUALITY OFFICER CONDUCTING CLINICAL AUDIT



BHCPF Q2 Quality Assessment

QUALITY OFFICERS CARRYING OUT ASSESSMENT AT FESTAC PHC



ILERA EKO Spotlight interview

INTERVIEW DURING WORLD PATIENT SAFETY DAY 2026

WHAT'S COMING

UPCOMING ACTIVITIES

STAY AHEAD, MARK YOUR CALENDAR



To contact the Quality assurance team for enquiries and further information Email: oakinsanmi@lashma.lagosstate.gov.ng Interested in publishing an article please contact Olawunmi on 08093934151